

**The 3-word format that got HubSpot cited 642% more by AI**

1 message

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Tue, Jun 23, 2026 at 8:32 AM

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To: Simon <sjc499@gmail.com>

Howdy Simon!

I recently read a post arguing that GEO is a brand positioning problem, not a technical one. The pitch: GEO lives at the executive level, the real upside is coordinating brand positioning and reputation across channels, and the SEO team only controls a sliver of how LLMs form an opinion of your brand.

I get why it's popular. It sounds smart and it's half true.

But I'd argue that the **SEO team** **has all the tools and know-how to make this actionable for CMOs. Like, why the F#% shouldn't SEOs, with all our know-how be the ones who demystify this for our clients?!* The slice of the SEO industry the article attempts to devalue is a very narrow definition of what it means to be an SEO in 2026.

This kind of post tells you the problem is bigger than you and lives above your pay grade. It attempts to reposition the conversation without handing you a single thing you can do about it on Monday morning, except of course hire the author.

That's the move with a lot of these takes. Long on "you're all thinking about this wrong," short on "here's what to do."

So today is the opposite. This is practical advice on how you, as an

SEO, can influence GEO at the company-wide level.

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Semantic Triples: Why Standalone Mentions Don't Cut it in AI Search

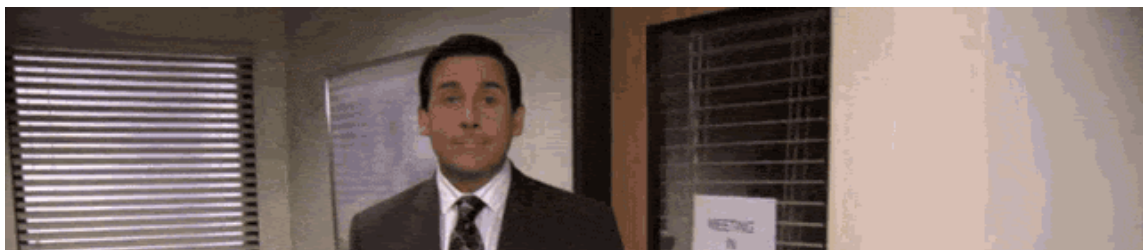
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Listen to this note (18 min): [Open audio](#)

We're starting with the most useful and most overlooked piece of technical know-how in the whole stack.

It's a format [Everett Sizemore](#) broke down in a post from last year, better than anyone I've seen. It's all about your brand positioning using **semantic triples**.

And once understood by your clients' org, it's a game changer... and yes, they can thank the SEO team for this!

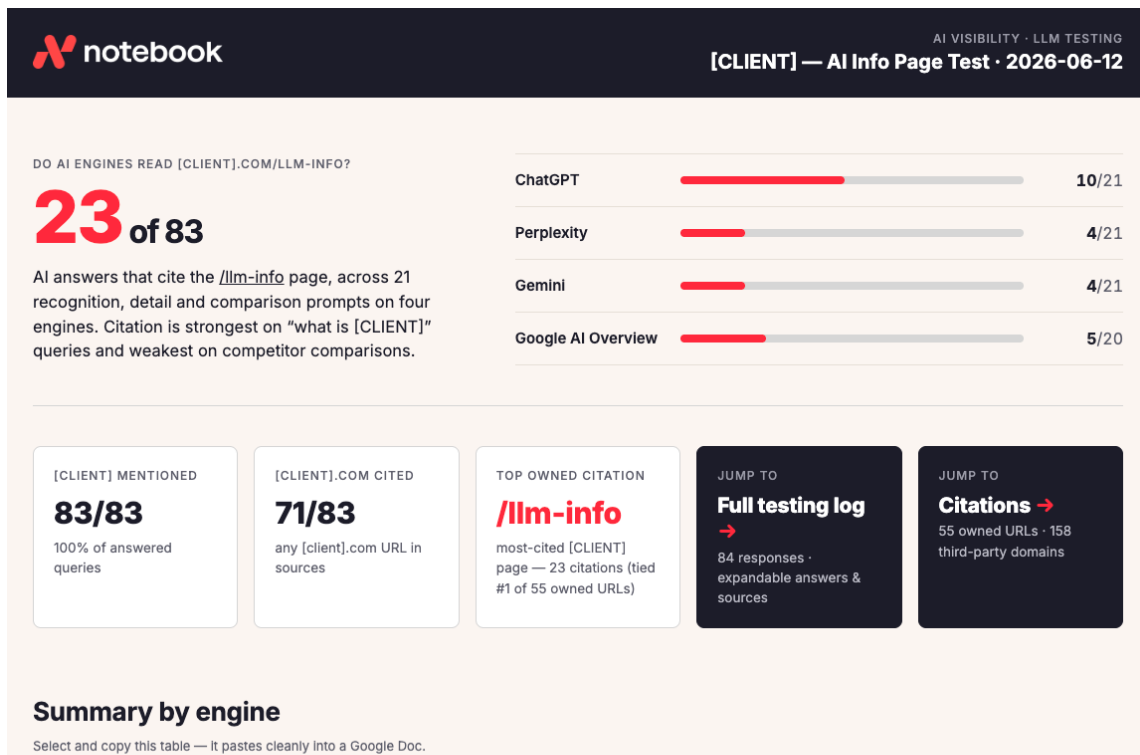




Mentions in AI are all the rage. Rand Fishkin will tell it to you [straight to your face](#), but a mention with no structure behind it is just your name floating in a sentence the model had to guess its way through.

A mention gets you named. A semantic triple helps the machine actually understand you. Those are very different outcomes.

P.S. The post also took jab at [AI Info Pages](#) touting them as a quick fix hack (which no one ever claimed). I mean, you can say all you want, they're making their way into [commoncrawl.org](#) and we have the receipts on how often they influence LLMs for key questions about our clients' brands.



ENGINE	ANSWERED	[CLIENT] MENTIONED	[CLIENT].COM CITED	/LLM-INFO CITED	ACCURATE / PARTIAL / INACCURATE
ChatGPT	21/21	21/21 (100%)	20/21 (95%)	10/21	6 / 14 / 1
Perplexity	21/21	21/21 (100%)	15/21 (71%)	4/21	5 / 16 / 0
Gemini	21/21	21/21 (100%)	20/21 (95%)	4/21	8 / 13 / 0
Google AI Overview	20/21	20/20 (100%)	16/20 (80%)	5/20	13 / 7 / 0

Owned citations — [CLIENT]

[client].com pages cited in AI responses. Click a row to see which prompts triggered the citation.
 ChatGPT appends ?utm_source=openai to its links (stripped here for grouping) — trackable in GA4.

PAGE URL	CITATIONS	ENGINES
* www.[client].com/blog/what-does-[client]-do	23	ChatGPT (7) Gemini (7) Perplexity (5) Google AI Overview (4)
* www.[client].com/llm-info /LLM-INFO	23	ChatGPT (10) Google AI Overview (5) Perplexity (4) Gemini (4)
* www.[client].com/	17	Gemini (8) Perplexity (5) Google AI Overview (4)
* www.[client].com/plans	11	Gemini (7) ChatGPT (3) Perplexity (1)
* www.[client].com/about	9	ChatGPT (4) Gemini (4) Perplexity (1)
* www.[client].com/features	7	ChatGPT (7)
* www.[client].com/blog/business-management-software-features	7	Gemini (7)

More on that in future note. Let's get into how you as an SEO can fix the GEO narrative problem for a CMO today...

The format: subject, predicate, object

A **semantic triple** is the smallest unit of fact a machine can read cleanly. Three parts, fixed order:

Subject - Predicate - Object.

"OpenAI developed ChatGPT." "Notebook Agency provides GEO strategy." Simple.

The order is not optional. Reverse it and you weaken the signal, because the object becomes the thing that took the action and the relationship gets fuzzy. Knowledge graphs, reasoning engines, and LLMs all expect that subject-first structure. Give them anything else and they start inferring.

And inference is exactly the problem.

A mention is presence. A triple is comprehension.

Here's the part most AEO advice skips.

When you land a mention inside a normal paragraph, the model sees your brand name but has to reconstruct what you are from the surrounding text. It reads the layout, the headings, the bold tags, and it takes a guess at the relationships you never spelled out.

Sometimes it guesses right. Often it gives you a weak description.

A mention wrapped in semantic triples does something different. It hands the model the entity *and* the relationships at the same time. Now the machine doesn't just know you exist. It knows what you do, who you serve, and when to put you in an answer.

Think of it like the difference between handing someone a labeled org chart versus making them rebuild the reporting structure from hallway gossip. Same names on the page. Wildly different comprehension.

So mentions plus triples beat mentions alone. Every time. One gets you named. The other gets you understood well enough to be cited.

I covered how Rand Fishkin basically uses this technique (without naming it) when he shares his bio for podcasts he does, I broke that down in this note: [Tweaking Your Bio to Improve LLM Search Performance](#)

Ok, Steve, let's see the data...

You don't have to take my word for it. **HubSpot** ran the experiment and [published the numbers](#).

Amanda Sellers' team took key info on pages they wanted AI to understand and rewrote it from paragraph format into bulleted semantic triples. The result, paired with their wider playbook: mentions of HubSpot in AI answers went up **58%**, and the number of times HubSpot pages got **cited** by AI went up **642%**.

Sit with that gap for a second.

Mentions rose by half. Citations rose by more than six times. The structure didn't just get them talked about more, it got them *used as a source* far more often. That's the multiplier. That's what triples do that a bare mention can't.

The honest caveat, straight from HubSpot's own team: no single tactic is the key. In fact, they call it the “everything bagel” strategy. Triples ran alongside schema, links, and the rest of their stack, and the sum of the parts is what moved the needle. This is similar to how SEOs have said “do all the things.”

Which is the whole point. As they put it, semantic triples are beneficial for SEO but **necessary** for AEO. Good SEO gets you in the room. Triples decide whether the model trusts you enough to quote you.

Peek the difference:

Unstructured Content Without Semantic Triples

With drag-and-drop functionality and an intuitive interface, this tool makes it easier than ever to build beautiful campaigns. It's packed with features that help you automate follow-ups, personalize messages, and analyze performance — no coding necessary.

Structured Content With Semantic Triples

- **HubSpot** offers an **email marketing tool** that supports drag-and-drop campaign creation.
- **Marketers can automate follow-ups** using built-in workflows.
- **HubSpot's email analytics** provide **insights** on open rates, click-throughs, and engagement trends.
- **No coding is required** to **design personalized emails**.

[Source](#)

Don't lose your SEO retainers to the agency that adds AEO first.

Book your [Power 25 hosted by Steve Toth](#)



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[Book an appointment](#)

2d • 

...

Excited to share that [Notebook Agency](#) is working with [Porter Airlines Inc.](#) on a full-scale AEO campaign.

Porter has built one of the most distinctive travel brands in North America, and we're helping them show up the same way inside AI search.

I've been a Porter customer for years, so this one hits different.

[#grateful](#)

porter x  notebook

When a category-defining airline **puts AEO on the budget**, the "is this real yet" question is over. Big-brand AEO is here, and the agencies in front of it are the ones their clients will trust to lead them through it.

Your prospects and clients are asking about AEO...

"How do we show up in ChatGPT?" "What's our AI search strategy?"
"Are we losing traffic to AI?" Most agencies don't have answers yet.
This session is designed to make sure you do.

Here's the thing. The agencies offering AEO and getting hired alongside you right now. They're gunning for your SEO retainers next. I'm not making this up. Here's exactly what came up on my last coaching call:

"We've been selling it as an individual line item. Most of our clients onboarding in the last three or four months are signing for a year. And there's like an 80% chance they get rid of their existing SEO team and bring us on for that too."

- Derek Iwasiuk - Chief AEO/SEO Officer - Search Tides

I'm opening up live [25-minute rapid-fire AEO strategy sessions](#) for \$597 hosted by me.

Money back guarantee if you don't walk away with 10x value.

Here's what you'll get:

On the call: We dig into your specific situation. Positioning for AI search and building AEO into your service offering. I'll also walk you through exactly how we've transformed Notebook Agency operations

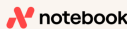
using Claude + Notion. And if we're having fun, who knows, maybe we go over.

After the call, you get:

- 1 Claude skill that creates Cowork tasks from any conversation (not shared publicly). This one compounds. Every client call, every internal discussion, every problem you solve becomes a documented process. It's the skill that builds more automatable skills.
- Edit access to my [LLM monitoring dashboard](#) (stand up your own branded instance)
- 3 exclusive SOPs from the [AEO Agency Accelerator](#) cohort (not shared publicly).
- How we use [Google's Vertex AI](#) to improve Google's retrievability and bring technical SEO thinking to AEO.
- I'll share a specific data collection strategy designed to help your site (or your client's site) stay ahead of 99% of competitors before this goes mainstream. This is the kind of early-mover advantage that structured data gave technical SEOs a decade ago.
- My 14 AEO page type guide that are the foundation for all Notebook Agency client engagements.

If your agency wants more high-intent bottom funnel LLM traffic, this session is built for you.

P.S. These are no-holds-barred sessions where you can invite up to three team members on the call (must share the same email address) and the calls will be recorded and shared along with access to your own personal plan 📌

 **notebook** POWER 25

Your Plan Mindset Deal Breakers Tools [Get the Notion Hub](#)

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Your competitors are still defining AEO. *You're*

about to own it.

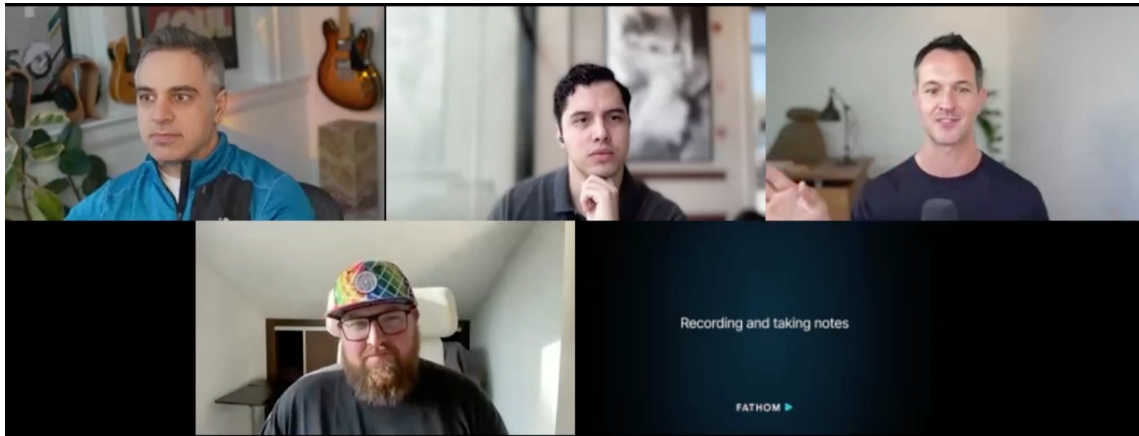
A condensed playbook from four Power25 consulting sessions with Steve Toth — the deal-breaker framework, the content page types that win citations, brand truth alignment, and the tools stack that powers it all.



Watch your Power25 call recording
Replay the full session with Steve, anytime



What Notebookers have to say...



“By the way, this is really great value, 600 bucks is a lot for a lot of people but like this is insanely dense and definitely have a positive ROI. So from the entrepreneur hat like this is just such a win for all parties involved.”

-Travis Jamison, Founder CapitalPad, Owner of the Chiang Mai SEO Conference

[Power 25 Sessions - Book now!](#)

Back to the note!

How to build your semantic triple positioning language

This prompt builds a structured "fact sheet" about a brand for AI search

visibility.

In plain terms: it takes a brand's website and breaks its positioning down into **semantic triples** — simple, three-part factual statements in the form Subject → Predicate → Object (for example, "Elderella → serves → family caregivers"). Think of it like translating fuzzy marketing prose into clean Lego-block facts. AI search tools like ChatGPT and Google's AI overviews read these tidy, self-contained statements far more reliably than they read paragraphs of website copy, so the output helps a brand show up correctly when AI systems describe it.

The prompt works in four steps:

1. **Collects inputs** — asks for the brand name, homepage URL, and an optional positioning statement, then waits.
2. **Reads and extracts** — visits the homepage and About page, pulling out what the brand offers, who it serves, its value propositions, and what sets it apart. It's constrained to use only what's actually on the pages (no inventing facts) and to ask first if something key is missing.
3. **Generates the triples** — produces 5 to 10 statements for each of four categories: Services/Offerings, Target Audience, Value Propositions, and Differentiators.
4. **Formats the output** — delivers everything in one table with columns for Subject, Predicate, Object, and Category.

The end result is a ready-to-use entity description that makes a brand's positioning legible to AI search engines.

Here's the exact prompt. Steal it.

```
Generate semantic triples (Subject-Predicate-Object statements) that describe a brand's positioning, for entity description and AI search visibility.
```

STEP 1 – Ask for inputs.

Ask me for these three things in one message, then stop and wait:

- Brand name (exactly as it should appear as the subject)
- Homepage URL
- Positioning statement (optional – paste it if I have one)

STEP 2 – Read the pages and extract positioning.

Read the homepage and the About page (follow the About link from the homepage). From those pages, pull out: what the brand offers, who it serves, its value propositions, and what differentiates it. If I gave a positioning statement, treat it as the source of truth and let the pages fill in the rest. Use only what's actually on the pages or what I told you – do not invent facts. If something important is missing or unclear, ask me before generating.

STEP 3 – Generate the triples.

Produce 5 to 10 triples for each category:

Services/Offerings, Target Audience, Value Propositions, Differentiators. Keep each triple factual, specific, and self-contained – each row should make sense on its own.

STEP 4 – Format.

Output a single table: Subject | Predicate |
Object | Category.

I ran this for the company [Elderella.com](https://elderella.com) (great idea for an btw)...

Subject	Predicate	Object	Category
Elderella	is	a family caregiving app for elder care, available on iOS and Android	Services/Offerings
Elderella	provides	Ella, an AI caregiving partner that captures care details from everyday conversations	Services/Offerings
Elderella	automatically creates	tasks, calendar events, medication entries, and care team records from chat updates	Services/Offerings
Elderella	offers	a shared care team feature for inviting family, friends, and professionals	Services/Offerings
Elderella	enables	medication management by photographing a medication label to auto-fill names and set reminders	Services/Offerings
Elderella	provides	note and document capture with search, replacing paper binders	Services/Offerings
Elderella	generates	care briefings and plans from conversations and notes	Services/Offerings
Elderella	offers	a shared, caregiving-focused calendar with assignable to-dos and recurring schedules	Services/Offerings
Elderella	serves	families supporting elderly loved ones	Target Audience
Elderella	is built for	family caregivers managing elder care	Target Audience

Once you've got your set, deploy triples everywhere LLMs read about you. On-page copy. FAQ blocks. Your structured data. Your AI Info Page. Third-party sources, everything from UGC sites, your LinkedIn company page, to press releases, content on page that are cited for prompts you care about. The goal is consistency, so the same clean facts show up across every surface and the model stops guessing. But before you go ham...

How to use semantic triples without alienating your audience

Hubspot uses the hilarious heuristic “Would reading this as a human make me throw my phone in the pool?”

They said it really well, so I've taken the following 5 tips from [this section of Hubspot's blog](#):

1. A little goes a long way.

“We need to find the happy medium between having the content be easily understood [by AI],” and having content that’s still enjoyable for humans to read. With a laugh, Sellers advises using the benchmark, **“Would reading this as a human make me throw my phone in the pool?”**

Instead of cramming semantic triples all over the page, **she suggests tossing in one triple for each core concept along the way.**

💡 Steve’s take: **“tossing in one triple for each core concept along the way” is the real gold nugget! Inspiration for a future note?! hmm.**

2. Target humans and bots with the same content.

You might think you could get around the need for the first tip by simply writing separate content for AI engines and for your human audience. Sellers (Hubspot) advises against this.

If AI or search engine crawlers discover your human-focused content, they may decide to penalize *both* pieces of content for being overly similar.

But worse is what happens when your human readers stumble over your bot content. A reputation for crappy content is hard to shake.

“We’re really trying to do a feed-two-birds-with-one-scone approach, because we have a massive readership that actually cares about what we write.”

3. Use answer-first phrasing.

Both humans and bots like to skim, and your content, however amazing, isn’t the exception. Your job is to make sure they can quickly get key information while skimming.

To that end, Sellers recommends using answer-first phrasing. So instead of a sentence like “According to recent research, pizza is delicious,” you might rewrite it as, “Pizza is delicious, according to recent research.”

A warning: Both human and software editors *absolutely hate this*. Do it anyway. This is a structure I absolutely insisted on when I was leading the HubSpot Blog’s user acquisition program.

4. Don’t bury the lede.

Similar to putting key info at the front of a sentence, you also want to make sure your semantic triples appear early within paragraphs.

Again, this makes it easy for human skimmers to quickly get the information they’re looking for. But for bots, it’s even more important, because they often take chunks of content out of context.

“Writers need to be conscientious about the order of sentences, so that **if an LLM came and took this one paragraph, it’s enough to represent the idea.**”

5. Think about mid-funnel and bottom-of-funnel content.

Product reviews, product comparisons, and listicles are all great places to employ semantic triples. Readers expect this kind of content to be simple and blunt, so semantic triples don't feel out of place.

It's also a natural opportunity to connect your brand to a product category, to certain features, or even... to your competitors.

“You want your entity to be associated with similar entities. So, for example, we want HubSpot associated with Salesforce or MailChimp. **That way, any time an AI engine mentions a competitor, it would be remiss to not also mention us in the same breath.**”

The bigger play this points to

Individual triples are the atoms. The molecule is one canonical, machine-readable page that every engine parses once and trusts for months.

This is exactly what I've been building toward with [EntityMap](#) and the [AI Info Page](#). A fact-dense source of truth that controls how machines describe your brand, instead of letting a stale review site do it for you. Triples are the language those pages are written in.

Get the atoms right first. We'll build the molecule and show the data in a future note.

Why this is also just good SEO

None of this is wasted on classic search.

Semantic triples are the native format of Google's **Knowledge Graph**, and they map almost one-to-one onto [Schema.org](https://schema.org) JSON-LD. So the work you do to get cited by ChatGPT is the same work that helps Google understand your entities and serve richer results.

Like I keep saying: good AEO overlaps with good SEO. It just doesn't stop there.

How Technical Skills and “Hacks” Can Impact GEO

Here's a concrete example:

Want to see the top brand mentions? Ask an SEO Notebooker reader or use this Google operator: [-site:clickup.com "clickup"](#). This will show you all the mentions for a brand that are not from the brand's website... SEO skills useful much? 🤔

In this Thursday's [AI Notebook](#), I'll share a prompt that helps you find influential third-party opportunities to add triples that help define your brand narrative using this operator.

It'll give CMOs the right mindset + an actionable directive that permeates across their company and all brand and product messaging.

Stay tuned and make sure you're signed up to the ainotebook.com list.

P.S. Quick tip for those of you who read to the end. Don't just stop at that [\[-site:brand.com "brand"\]](#) search. Think about the fanouts for your money keywords, too (possible alternative to track citable source like I mentioned [here](#)). Worth a test. I'll leave it to you to ponder and will cover more in a future note.

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Hey! I'm Steve Toth

Founder of SEO Notebook, Notebook Agency and AI Notebook.

AI Search is changing everything. We help you stay visible.

Book time with us.

Let's talk

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